THE WITNESS

THE LINDER CASE

A verified route to the guilty conviction

BEST OUTCOME	INPUTS	PLAYER DEATHS	INSTRUCTIONS
Guilty verdict	**86**	**0**	**164,723**

Verified story: Z-machine V3, Release 22, Serial 840924. This fresh-game route ends with Monica Linder convicted of murdering her father. The game has no numeric score command; the conviction is the strongest verified case outcome. The murder itself is scripted. No player death occurs.

How to use this guide

Follow the stages in order and enter each Courier command as written. Responses to YES/NO questions are listed as commands. The opening wait sequence advances the investigation to the 9 p.m. murder; later waits let Duffy complete the powder and autopsy work and let Monica move between rooms.

Route checkpoints

The exact replay consumes 86 inputs and 164,723 VM instructions. It examines the crime scene, obtains corroboration from the powder lab and autopsy, interviews Monica, finds the key and handgun hidden on her, then makes the arrest. The final Chief's letter confirms conviction.

Story fingerprint: SHA-256 F9114633540AFA98C3BB97D1B07FFAFD0C0AA20CE179D48AA7E5F46953E0904D

The opcode inventory uses 1-based instruction sequence numbers and hexadecimal byte addresses.

01. Reach the house and witness the murder

From the driveway, approach the house and wait in the living room. Sit in the wooden chair when the game offers the choice. Continue through the 9 p.m. wait prompt; the murder is an unavoidable story event.

```
north
north
ring bell
east
wait
sit in chair
wooden chair
wait (repeat five times)
yes
wait
wait
```

02. Secure the scene

Stand and inspect the clock, keyhole, and window. Take the wire and use the key to open the back door. These observations establish how the scene was arranged.

```
stand
press button
examine clock
take key
examine keyhole
examine window
take wire
unlock back door
open back door
```

03. Find the gun and the receipt

Go to the garden and retrieve the muddy gun. Check it for powder, then enter the butler’s pantry and study the mystery book and its receipt. The receipt points to a two-gun purchase; keep it as evidence.

```
east
south
take gun
north
west
check powder
west
north
north
open butler door
west
open mystery book
take receipt
read receipt
```

04. Use the garage and powder lab

Unlock the garage and workshop. Ask Duffy to test the wire and muddy handgun; wait for his reports. This route establishes the wire’s ordinary composition and the gun’s recent firing.

```
east
south
south
unlock garage door
open garage door
south
unlock work door
open work door
east
wait for Duffy
check piece
wait for Duffy
analyze muddy handgun
wait for Duffy
```

05. Interview Monica

Wait for Monica’s movements, then follow the listed route from the workshop to her bedroom. Speak with her about Mr. Linder. Wait until she leaves, answering NO when the game asks whether to continue waiting after she has gone.

```
wait for Monica
wait (repeat four times)
no
west
north
east
west
north
north
east
wait for Monica
monica, tell me about mr linder
wait (repeat five times)
no
```

06. Recover the hidden evidence and make the arrest

Return to the office/lounge after Monica leaves the bedroom. Handcuff her before searching. The first search finds a key; unlock and open the clock, then search her again to find the handgun. Wait for Duffy’s autopsy report, arrest Monica, and answer YES. Answer NO to the optional author summary to finish.

```
west
south
south
east
handcuff monica
search monica
unlock clock
open clock
search monica
wait for Duffy
arrest Monica
yes
no
```

Completion check: the story halts after the Chief’s letter reports Monica’s conviction. This is a complete solution; there is no player death.

Executed opcode inventory

58 unique opcodes were observed across 164,723 instructions in the fresh-game route. The counts include all executed VM instructions. Opcode numbers are hexadecimal; the instruction form distinguishes encodings. PCs are byte addresses.

Form	Opcode	Mnemonic	Count	First seq.	First PC
Long	0x0D	store	5,854	1	0x00CDB9
Variable	0x00	call	7,185	5	0x00CDC5
Short	0x00	rtrue	541	8	0x00BB29
Short	0x03	get_parent	1,737	11	0x00D340
Short	0x0B	ret	1,788	12	0x00D343
Long	0x0A	test_attr	2,497	14	0x00CDD4
Variable	0x14	add	339	18	0x00CCFF
Long	0x14	add	7,714	19	0x00CD05
Long	0x01	je	19,203	20	0x00CD09
Long	0x15	sub	5,540	21	0x00CD0D
Short	0x00	jz	31,321	22	0x00CD11
Variable	0x01	storew	5,953	24	0x00CD1C
Long	0x0F	loadw	22,196	34	0x00CD23
Short	0x0C	jump	15,204	37	0x00CD31
Short	0x02	print	477	438	0x01297B
Short	0x0B	new_line	234	439	0x012A82
Short	0x03	print_ret	43	440	0x012A83
Long	0x10	loadb	1,938	444	0x00EF0B
Long	0x09	and	434	445	0x00EF0F
Variable	0x09	and	1	450	0x00EFCC
Variable	0x06	print_num	50	451	0x00EFD2
Long	0x05	inc_chk	7,590	453	0x00EFE4
Variable	0x05	print_char	11	455	0x00EFEF
Long	0x0E	insert_obj	128	482	0x00CDED
Variable	0x08	push	849	486	0x00F146
Variable	0x09	pull	62	488	0x00F14F
Long	0x0B	set_attr	96	490	0x00F156
Long	0x06	jin	780	493	0x00F15F
Short	0x0D	print_paddr	71	498	0x00F17C
Variable	0x01	je	3,004	500	0x00BAF1
Short	0x0A	print_obj	65	509	0x00F187
Long	0x11	get_prop	1,330	519	0x00F203
Long	0x02	jl	1,763	535	0x0073FA
Short	0x02	get_child	1,584	546	0x00746E
Short	0x01	get_sibling	1,532	549	0x007503
Short	0x05	inc	1,143	556	0x007510
Short	0x08	ret_popped	656	677	0x00F124
Long	0x04	dec_chk	770	734	0x00D452
Variable	0x04	sread	86	745	0x00D484
Long	0x07	test	891	766	0x00D7CD
Long	0x03	jg	4,127	767	0x00D7D1

Form	Opcode	Mnemonic	Count	First seq.	First PC
Short	0x01	rfalse	1,329	813	0x00502D
Long	0x12	get_prop_addr	2,722	855	0x012721
Short	0x04	get_prop_len	1,509	857	0x012729
Variable	0x03	jg	282	1,142	0x00CD48
Long	0x16	mul	183	1,255	0x014491
Variable	0x07	random	18	1,256	0x014495
Variable	0x0D	store	48	1,332	0x00D347
Variable	0x02	storeb	105	2,060	0x00D666
Long	0x0C	clear_attr	76	2,257	0x00E36A
Long	0x17	div	1,271	2,271	0x00E755
Variable	0x15	sub	2	4,142	0x0143CB
Variable	0x02	jl	6	4,349	0x013D6A
Long	0x13	get_next_prop	141	4,544	0x014C81
Short	0x0C	show_status	213	5,502	0x012548
Long	0x18	mod	24	8,232	0x00ED44
Short	0x09	remove_obj	6	28,793	0x014336
Short	0x0A	quit	1	164,723	0x017C74

Replay completion: Halted; output SHA-256 C33F525AB108CE5F5A9A5DE430EF53793206B0239E3C74A973937848B5B64F3B. The deterministic route and instruction trace are local under .agent/regression-routes/ and intentionally ignored by Git.